THE HISTORY DEPARTMENT

Marking & Feedback Policy

THE TRIPARTITE CURRICULUM ARCHITECTURE

1. MASTER TEXTBOOKS
2. PUPIL WORKBOOKS
3. RETRIEVAL COMPANIONS

Approved for Academic Year 2026–2027

Department Lead • The History Revision Hub Platform Standards

Part 1: Departmental Rationale & Tripartite Architecture

The History Department prioritises meaningful, manageable, and motivating feedback, focusing on high-impact live intervention, whole-class modelling, and structured pupil self-regulation over performative red-pen marking. Our feedback system is integrated into a unified **Tripartite Curriculum Model**:

PILLAR 1: MASTER TEXTBOOKS

Pure narrative reading anthologies (zero source boxes, zero rubrics) providing immersive, high-challenge prose during whole-class reading before writing begins.

PILLAR 2: PUPIL WORKBOOKS

16–20 page saddle-stitch workbooks. Verso: 5-Stage Chronological Inquiry Spine; Recto: Disciplinary writing on calibrated ~7.8mm–8.1mm ruled handwriting lines.

PILLAR 3: RETRIEVAL COMPANIONS

8-page (KS3) and 16–28 page (GCSE) companions featuring Domino causal flowcharts, 2-line dual retrieval, and self-scoring Marking Banks.

Centring Pupil Voice & Live Metacognition

Feedback is an active dialogue, not a retrospective teacher chore. Live marking during circulating coaching prompts pupils to vocalise historical reasoning, correct misconceptions in real time with green pen, and complete end-of-unit reflection grids in their workbooks to document progress and set immediate targets.

Zero Knowledge Giveaways in Scaffolds

Sentence stems and connectives in pupil workbooks provide purely structural, disciplinary scaffolding—never factual answers. Key Terms banks supply technical vocabulary (e.g. *Diktat, Article 231, £6.6bn reparations*), but connectives remain strictly content-free (e.g. *In particular, a decisive factor was...*), forcing pupils to retrieve historical knowledge from memory rather than transcribing hints.

Frequency of Marking

Key Stage 3

Routine classwork is reviewed via live circulating coaching and self-marking with the Knowledge Retrieval Companion's Marking Bank. Teachers assess one substantial disciplinary extended writing task (Explain Why 12m, Narrative Account 8m, or Interpretations 8m) per half term using the 5 Pathway Levels.

Key Stage 4 (GCSE)

Regular low-stakes rehearsals using Pearson Edexcel past questions. Teachers provide live exemplar modelling and mark formal timed assessments across Paper 1 (Medicine & Western Front), Paper 2 (Elizabeth & Middle East), and Paper 3 (Weimar & USA) against Pearson 9–1 mark criteria and CAT4 benchmarks.

Part 2: Standards, Grading & Feedback Types

Types of Marking & Feedback

1. Live In-The-Moment Coaching

Teacher circulates while pupils write on ruled lines, checking historical precision and intervening immediately with verbal coaching and green-pen margin codes.

2. Retrieval Companion Self-Scoring

Pupils complete low-stakes starters and self-mark immediately using the verified Marking Bank at the back of the companion, cementing factual recall and schema retention.

3. Disciplinary Writing Assessment

End-of-enquiry written pieces are assessed against national progression criteria (KS3) or Pearson Edexcel 9–1 criteria (GCSE), recorded on the workbook back cover ledger.

4. Spaced App Quizzing & QR Retrieval

Dual-QR codes on workbook back covers link pupils directly to interactive 20-question digital quizzes on the History Revision Hub, automating diagnostics and homework retrieval.

Spelling, Punctuation & Grammar (SPaG)

Consistent whole-school marking symbols applied across all humanities written work:

Symbol	Meaning	Symbol	Meaning
Sp	Incorrect spelling (write 3x in margin)	^	Word omitted
P	Punctuation error (. , ! ?)	?	Meaning unclear / historical confusion
G	Grammar error / sentence structure	!	Factual / chronological inaccuracy
C	Capital letter required (proper noun/date)	✓	Valid historical evidence / explanation
//	New paragraph required	✓✓	Exceptional analytical insight / causal link

Assessment & Grading Framework

Progress tracking is maintained using the ledger on the inside front/back cover of workbooks, aligned to national standards and indicative GCSE outcomes:

Pathway Level	Score Band	Indicative GCSE	Disciplinary Writing Standard
GD (Greater Depth)	80% – 100%	Grades 8 – 9	Sustained causal argument, conceptual hierarchy, nuanced evaluation.
Exp + (Expected +)	60% – 79%	Grades 6 – 7	Consistent analytical structure, detailed evidence deployment, clear links.
Exp (Expected)	40% – 59%	Grades 4 – 5	Accurate historical knowledge, structured explanation, sound PEEL points.
EM + (Emerging +)	30% – 39%	Grade 3	Descriptive accounts, basic causal awareness, emerging terminology.
EM (Emerging)	10% – 29%	Grades 1 – 2	Fragmentary recall, simple narrative statements requiring teacher guidance.

Part 3: Exemplar Implementation & Visual Evidence (Key Stage 3)

VISUAL APPENDIX • KS3

Key Stage 3 workbooks embed our double-page spread architecture: Verso inquiry spine [1.1]–[5.5] with left-trigger keywords; Recto writing tasks on calibrated ~7.8mm–8.1mm handwriting pitch with zero knowledge giveaways in scaffolds.



PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER — TARGET GRADE: _____

Level	Emerging (1-2)	Emerging+ (3)	Expected (4-5)	Expected+ (6-7) / Greater Depth (8-9)

Lesson / Assessment Title	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments
L1: Lesson 1: 1066 - Why did three men claim one throne, and how did William win?			
L2: Lesson 2: Castles, Terror, and the Domesday Book - How did William control England?			
L3: Lesson 3: Crown vs Church: Why did Henry II clash with Thomas Becket?			
L4: Lesson 4: Magna Carta (1215): A triumph of liberty or a selfish baronial power grab?			
L5: Lesson 5: Doom Paintings and Tithes: What was life like in a medieval village?			
L6: Lesson 6: 1348: How did the Black Death shatter medieval social order?			
L7: Lesson 7: 1381: Why did the Peasants revolt, and did they achieve anything?			
L8: Lesson 8: The Wars of the Roses (1455–1485) - How did the medieval era end in blood?			
L9: Lesson 9: Assessment: How powerful was a medieval monarch?			
Final Unit Grades:			

Figure 1: Progress & Assessment Ledger (KS3 Workbook). Lesson-by-lesson audit trail recording Effort (1–5), Pathway Standard (EM to GD), and formative teacher/pupil dialogue.

Dual-Pathway Centrefold Timeline

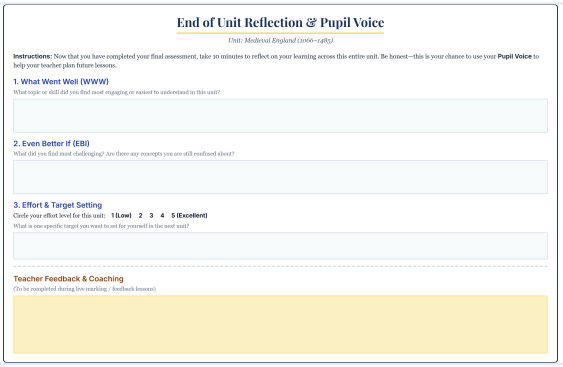
The centrefold (Pages 8–9 or 10–11) features our Panoramic Living Timeline with a binary dual-coding protocol:

- **Choice A (Visual Dual-Coding):** Pupils draw a symbolic icon representing the decisive causal mechanism.
- **Choice B (Concept Mind Map):** Pupils construct a 3-branch analytical web linking cause, event, and consequence.

Effort Scoring Rubric (1–5)

Score	Pupil Focus & Diligence
5 • Exemplary	Proactive curiosity; voluntary extension; exceptional pride.
4 • Good	Consistent engagement; thoughtful contributions; complete work.
3 • Satisfactory	Meets baseline; requires occasional prompting.
2 • Inconsistent	Incomplete written tasks; frequent off-task reminders.
1 • Concern	Persistent passivity; triggers departmental intervention.

Visual Evidence: End-of-Unit Reflection & Pupil Voice



End of Unit Reflection & Pupil Voice

Unit: Medieval England (1066–1485)

Instructions: Now that you have completed your final assessment, take 10 minutes to reflect on your learning across this entire unit. Be honest—this is your chance to use your **Pupil Voice** to help your teacher plan future lessons.

1. What Went Well (WWW)

What topic or skill did you find most engaging or easiest to understand in this unit?

2. Even Better If (EBI)

What did you find most challenging? Are there any concepts you are still confused about?

3. Effort & Target Setting

Circle your effort level for this unit: 1 (Low) 2 3 4 5 (Excellent)

What is one specific target you want to set for yourself in the next unit?

Teacher Feedback & Coaching

(To be completed during live marking / feedback lessons)

Figure 2: End of Unit Metacognitive Reflection & Pupil Voice (Workbook Final Page). Students record What Went Well (WWW), Even Better If (EBI), self-score effort (1–5), and set forward targets validated through teacher coaching.

Part 4: Exemplar Implementation & Visual Evidence (Key Stage 4)

VISUAL APPENDIX • KS4

At Key Stage 4, feedback is structured around Pearson Edexcel exam question tariffs, PEEL writing frames with content-free connectives, and targeted question intelligence:

SECTION B PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER (36+4 MARKS TOTAL)

Marked by Teacher or Peer Verified

Assessment Component & Stem Focus	Format Style	Max Marks	Pupil Score
Complete 4-Era Knowledge Vault (All 280 Recall Questions)	Checklist	/280	____
Round 1 (Stepped): Q3 Similarity / Difference (Medieval vs Renaissance)	Stepped Ladder	/4	____
Round 1 (Stepped): Q4 Explain Why (Surgical Progress c1700–c1900)	Stepped Ladder	/12	____
Round 1 (Stepped): Q5/Q6 Statement Essay (Germ Theory vs Public Health)	Stepped Ladder	/16+4	____
Round 2 (Dual-Track): Q3 Similarity / Difference (Great Plague vs Black Death)	Dual Track	/4	____
Round 2 (Dual-Track): Q4 Explain Why (Penicillin Mass Production c1938–45)	Dual Track	/12	____
Round 2 (Dual-Track): Q5/Q6 Statement Essay (Four Humours c1250–c1700)	Dual Track	/16+4	____
Round 3 (Simulation): Section B Full Exam Hall Simulation (Q3, Q4, Q5/6)	Exam Pitch (55m)	/36+4	____
TOTAL COMBINED EXAM PRACTICE MARKS:		**/104**	**____ / 104**

Teacher / Peer Marker: _____ Date: _____ Overall Grade: [9 8 7 6 5 4]

Figure 3: GCSE Section B Progress & Assessment Tracker (Edexcel Medicine Master Suite). Tracks student progression across Round 1 (Stepped Enquiries with PEEL scaffolding), Round 2 (Dual-Track Enquiries for Grades 7–9), and Round 3 (Timed 55-minute Exam Hall Simulations).

Specification-Specific Question Tariffs

- **Paper 1 (Western Front):** Feature questions exist *strictly* as two separate 2-mark questions: Q1(a) [2m] and Q1(b) [2m].
- **Paper 2 (Elizabethan):** Two distinct 2-mark feature questions: Q1(a) [2m] and Q1(b) [2m].
- **Paper 2 (Middle East):** Updated single 4-mark consequence format ('Explain one consequence of...').

Provenance Clues ('How Useful' Utility Prompts)

Scaffolding boxes guide students to evaluate **Author** (access, expertise), **Audience** (private diary vs mass propaganda), and **Motive** (substantive purpose) against verified historical context, eliminating generic speculation.

Longitudinal Exam Trend Intelligence & Automated Quizzing

QUESTION FOCUS	2018	2019	2020	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026
Section A: Western Front Historic Environment Enquiry 16m (Q1 Features: 4m • Q2a Utility: 8m • Q2b Follow-Up: 4m)	SECTION A [16m] **Treatment of Battle Injuries** Q1: • Q2a: • Q2b: 4m 8m 4m	SECTION A [16m] **Stretcher Bearers** Q1: • Q2a: • Q2b: 4m 8m 4m	SECTION A [16m] **Gas Attacks** Q1: • Q2a: • Q2b: 4m 8m 4m	SECTION A [16m] **Trench Foot** Q1: • Q2a: • Q2b: 4m 8m 4m	SECTION A [16m] **New Techniques to Deal with Injuries** Q1: • Q2a: • Q2b: 4m 8m 4m	SECTION A [16m] **Medical Staff in Casualty Clearing Stations** Q1: • Q2a: • Q2b: 4m 8m 4m	SECTION A [16m] **Difficulties in Caring for the Wounded** Q1: • Q2a: • Q2b: 4m 8m 4m	SECTION A [16m] **Transporting Wounded Along Evacuation Chain** Q1: • Q2a: • Q2b: 4m 8m 4m
Q3: Similarity / Difference 4m (Thematic c1250-present)	Q3 [4m] Medieval vs Industrial Hospital Care	Q3 [4m] Ideas About Causes of Illness: 18th/19th Century vs Modern	Q3 [4m] Medieval Physician vs NHS Doctor	Q3 [4m] Preventing Infectious Diseases: Renaissance vs Industrial	Q3 [4m] Prevention of Illness: Medieval vs Modern	Q3 [4m] Treatment of Infectious Diseases: Medieval vs Modern	Q3 [4m] Epidemics: Great Plague (1665) vs Cholera (1854)	Q3 [4m] Preventing Infectious Diseases: Renaissance vs Modern
Q4: Causation Explanation 12m (Thematic c1250-present)	Q4 [12m] Prevention of Illness c1700-present	Q4 [12m] Renaissance Medical Knowledge c1500-c1700	Q4 [12m] Science & Technology in Modern Medicine c1900-present	Q4 [12m] Attitudes Towards Surgery c1800-present	Q4 [12m] Access to Medical Care & Treatment in Modern Period	Q4 [12m] Why Little Change in Medieval Medicine c1250-c1500	Q4 [12m] Impact of Pasteur's Germ Theory c1861-present	Q4 [12m] Hospital Care & Treatment Improvements c1700-c1900
Q5: Judgement Essay (Choice A) 16m + 4m SPaG (Extended)	Q5 [16m] Understanding Cause of Disease c1250-c1700	Q5 [16m] Galen & Medieval Medical Care c1250-c1500	Q5 [16m] Florence Nightingale & Hospital Care c1700-c1900	Q5 [16m] Medieval Care & Treatment: Role of Physician c1250-c1500	Q5 [16m] Thomas Sydenham as Key Turning Point c1500-c1700	Q5 [16m] Progress in Medical Knowledge in Renaissance c1500-c1700	Q5 [16m] Four Humours & Medicine c1250-c1700	Q5 [16m] Medieval Ideas on Cause of Illness: Religion vs Nature c1250-c1500
Q6: Judgement Essay (Choice B) 16m + 4m SPaG (Extended)	Q6 [16m] Advances in Surgery: 18th/19th Century vs 20th Century	Q6 [16m] Role of Government in Medicine c1800-present	Q6 [16m] Infectious Diseases c1500-c1900	Q6 [16m] Pasteur & Causes of Illness c1800-present	Q6 [16m] Attitudes Towards Medicine c1700-c1900	Q6 [16m] Role of Individuals in Prevention c1700-present	Q6 [16m] Role of Government in Hospital Care c1800-present	Q6 [16m] Science & Technology as Main Reason for Modern Progress c1900-present

Figure 4: Pearson Edexcel Past Exam Question Matrix (8-Series Analysis, 2018–2026). Departmental tracking across Medicine, Elizabethan, Middle East, Germany, and USA. Flags unexamined syllabus themes, allowing teachers to deliver high-yield classroom rehearsals and automated 20-question mastery quizzes.